# Nielsen’s 10 Heuristics (easy meanings + what to look for)

1) Visibility of system status
Meaning: System should always tell what’s going on.
Look for on screen:
• Loading indicators, success/error messages, “Saved!”, progress bars.
Violation examples:
• You click “Submit” and nothing happens (no loading / no confirmation).

2) Match between system and real world
Meaning: Use user language, not developer terms.
Look for:
• Simple labels like “Orders”, “Delivery Date”, “Total Price”.
Violation:
• Labels like cust_id, tbl_orders, “execute”, “payload”.

3) User control and freedom
Meaning: Users need undo/cancel/back.
Look for:
• Cancel button, Back button, undo delete, “Are you sure?”.
Violation:
• User opens edit page but no cancel; delete happens instantly with no confirmation.

4) Consistency and standards
Meaning: Same things should look/behave same everywhere.
Look for:
• Same button styles, same naming (“Add” vs “Create”), icons used consistently.
Violation:
• “Save” on one screen but “Submit” elsewhere doing same thing; inconsistent date formats.

5) Error prevention
Meaning: Prevent mistakes before they happen.
Look for:
• Required field marks (*), input constraints, disabled submit until valid.
Violation:
• Allows submitting empty form; no validation; delete button placed too close to edit.

6) Recognition rather than recall
Meaning: Don’t make users remember; show options.
Look for:
• Dropdowns, visible filters, suggestions, breadcrumbs.
Violation:
• User must remember product code from previous page to enter here.

7) Flexibility and efficiency of use
Meaning: Power users should work faster.
Look for:
• Search, filters, keyboard navigation, bulk actions.
Violation:
• Large list but no search/filter; must scroll forever.

8) Aesthetic and minimalist design
Meaning: No unnecessary clutter.

Look for:
• Clean layout, grouped fields, good spacing.
Violation:
• Too many fields at once; too many colors; crowded page.

9) Help users recognize, diagnose, and recover from errors
Meaning: Errors should be clear and helpful.
Look for:
• “Email is invalid” (not “Error 400”).
Violation:
• Message: “Something went wrong” with no hint; field not highlighted.

10) Help and documentation
Meaning: Provide help when needed.
Look for:
• Tooltips, help icon, short instructions, placeholder examples.
Violation:
• Complex form but zero hints; user doesn’t know required format.